

Dev-log for Message Game - Cook human on time

<https://joshuarabbit.itch.io/cook-human-on-time>

Cheng Min

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Personal Aims

1. Design an engaging game expressing metaphor information to players effectively portrays the concept of the social clock through a lighthearted and clever approach.

In this game, the social clock will be presented as a central theme, exploring the societal expectations and pressures individuals face at different stages of their lives. The aim is to create an immersive experience that not only entertains players but also provokes reflection on the concept of the social clock.

2. Enhance player engagement and immersion by employing strategic modifications to the game's values, particularly focusing on amplifying the sense of urgency.

By strategically adjusting various game parameters, such as time constraints, task difficulty, and consequences for inaction, we can intensify the player's perception of urgency. This heightened urgency aims to generate a feeling of oppression within the social clock, effectively immersing the player in the game world and enhancing their emotional connection to the gameplay experience.

3. Develop a user interface (UI) that effectively communicates the necessary information while maintaining clarity and simplicity.

The UI design should strike a balance between providing essential information and ensuring a streamlined and intuitive user experience. It should convey relevant game mechanics, progress tracking, and other pertinent details in a visually appealing and easily understandable manner. The goal is to avoid overwhelming or confusing the player with excessive visual clutter, allowing them to focus on the gameplay itself without distraction.

Game Overview

1. Overview

Cook Human on time is a unique simulation game that revolves around the concept of the social clock. In this game, players assume the role of a Great Chef, where their objective is to prepare human ingredients within the appropriate time frames by washing them in the sink and cooking them in the pot, ect.



2. Game Concept

Conveyed Message

The social clock refers to the cultural framework that establishes the timeline for significant social milestones in an individual's life, exerting pressure on individuals to achieve them. These pivotal milestones typically encompass aspects such as employment, marriage, and parenthood. Failure to attain these milestones within specific age parameters often leads to individuals being stigmatized as unsuccessful, particularly within the context of Asian culture.

3. Gameplay

Great Parent Role

Players will take on the role of a Great parent, which is a skilled Great Chef too, responsible for managing the timely preparation of human ingredients.

They will navigate various activities and challenges tied to different social clock requirements.

Time Management

The game requires players to carefully plan and execute tasks within specific time limits.

Players must prioritize activities to ensure the human ingredients are cooked on time so that when taste the slice of human, they would get a high score.

Social Clock Milestones

The game features a range of social clock milestones represented by different things in the kitchen.

Players must wash the ingredients in the sink (school) and cook them in the pot (work) to progress.

Decision-Making

Players will encounter choices that affect the progress and outcome of their culinary journey.

Decisions regarding time allocation will impact the game's success.

Challenges and Rewards

The game presents various challenges, such as time constraints and ingredient quality (study/work level and age).

Successfully meeting these challenges will give your children (cooked humans) a high score from the whole society to become a perfect elite.

4. Significance

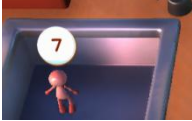
Why we choose this topic

The social clock theme is derived from the pressures that permeate our lives, and this game draws inspiration from the slice-of-life genre during the game jam era. This phenomenon is

particularly pronounced in Asian cultures, where societies have established rigid timelines for significant social milestones. In countries such as China, Japan, Korea, and India, there are explicit expectations for individuals to achieve specific milestones within certain timeframes. Attaining higher education, securing stable employment, marrying, and having a baby at an appropriate age are considered benchmarks of personal success and societal acceptance in these cultures. Those who deviate from these prescribed timelines may face scrutiny and criticism from family, society, and close acquaintances.

Therefore, we designed this game with the intention of allowing players to experience this pressure firsthand. However, we deliberately chose to incorporate elements of humour and even absurdity in its design. Our aim is to express our dissent towards the social clock concept. By adopting a light-hearted and whimsical approach, we hope to create a space for reflection and questioning of societal expectations. Through the game's playful nature, we encourage players to challenge the rigidity of the social clock and explore alternative perspectives on personal fulfilment and success.

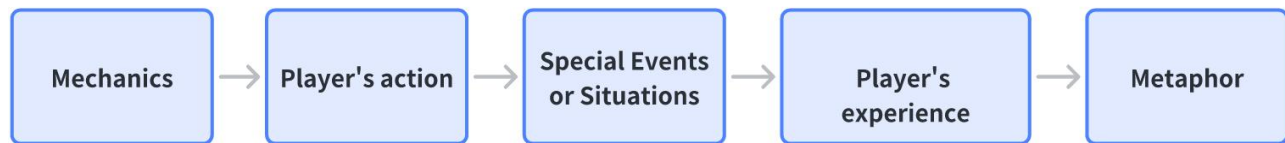
Metaphors in the game

The object	The concept in reality	The ScreenShot
Food (ingredient)	Pink human (woman) Blue human (man)	
Sink	School	
Wash the food	Study in school	
Pots	Workplace	
Cook the human	Working	
Toast two pieces of human (bread) in the toaster	Get married	
Serve the human on a plate	Retirement	
Let customers taste it	The social clock may assess the worth of your life.	

Parents' Efforts		
Name	Function	Metaphor
Tiger Mother	Improve learning efficiency.	Some mothers who are too strict with their children are likened to tigers in East Asian society. They scold and even beat their children when they do not do well in school.
Early Bird	A newborn baby can go to school.	To motivate their children to win from birth, East Asian parents will send their children to learn various skills such as dancing, singing and musical instruments at a very young age.
Magic Belly	Can give birth to twins.	This skill is only triggered when there are very few people during the game, which corresponds to the reality that very few people have twins . This skill is designed to reduce the difficulty of the game and to ensure that the player has enough resources (humans) to continue playing
Working Student	Can gain work experience in school after the age of 16.	Some students will take part-time jobs while studying
Internship King	Can do all jobs after the age of 18.	Some students will join the company on an internship before they graduate.
Fetal Education	A newborn baby gets initial Education.	The East Asian incentive for children to study has been involuted in fetal education . Parents who possess this skill can start their children learning as soon as they are born.
Network	Reduce educational requirements of all jobs.	This skill is designed to reduce the difficulty of the game that players can arrange human (child) to work easily
Supervision	Improve working efficiency.	In the East Asian workplace, there is often a role of supervisor , mostly a leader in the company. They will monitor whether staff are serious about their work and squeeze as much value out of them as possible.
No End To Learn	Keep studying when working.	Study at the same time as you work. Such people tend to put in more effort to catch up with others and improve themselves.

Bribe	Reduce marriage requirements temporarily.	This skill refreshes the marriage requirement for both men and women (it must be lowered) and requires a total score each time it is used, and the credit increases gradually. This skill is designed to reduce the difficulty of the game and to ensure that the player can keep going.
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Metaphor generated from the player's action or experience



A kind of emergent narrative

Below is a table summarising some **metaphors** that can generate from the **player's actions** when they interact with our **mechanic**.

The possible situation happens in the game	Metaphors
Players reflect	
The players may be stuck in chaos in the face of thousands of Overcook humans. 	Parents of large families often find it challenging to devote enough energy to care for each of their children. In East Asian societies, particularly in China, where there is a push for families to have three children, the pressure on both parents and children to adhere to societal expectations can be overwhelming.
Players have expressed their opinion that the game is highly fast-paced, often leaving them feeling overwhelmed and frazzled.	Our intention was for players to experience a profound sense of urgency, anxiety, and pressure. These pressures arise from the game's constantly advancing and non-pausable nature, symbolizing the anxieties associated with age. Moreover, players are required to place each ingredient precisely and swiftly into its corresponding cooking step, serving as a metaphor for the societal demands dictated by the social clock.
Study	
Players can get extra bonus scores if a human is dragged to the Studying Sink before 8 years old, while players will get a	There exists a social phenomenon where parents are increasingly motivated to enrol their children in school at the earliest

penalty if a human starts studying after 12 years old. Early School! 220 Late for School! -660	possible age, driven by the desire for competitive advantage. Parents hope to position their children as winners right from the start. However, the reality is that children are being exposed to an excessive amount of advanced learning, to the extent that they are experiencing undue pressure and missing out on a wholesome childhood.
Players will incur penalties, in terms of taste and score, if there is a human character occupying the Studying Sink beyond the age of 28. Delay Graduate? -900 	In East Asia, there are students who willingly postpone their graduation in order to allocate more time for studying or better prepare for finding a job. However, delaying graduation results in the Social Clock downgrading these individuals, thereby incurring penalties. Additionally, in East Asian culture, there is a preference to complete one's entire academic journey, including undergraduate, and graduate (master's or Ph.D.), before entering the workforce. It is uncommon for individuals to return to school for further education after a period of employment.
If a human is older than 16 years old but isn't staying at Studying Sink or Working Pots, this will be considered a 'gap year', and a penalty will be caused. Gap 15 Year? -2050 	HR departments may also devalue a candidate's profile due to a gap year and inquire about their activities during that period. They generally favour individuals who have maintained consistent employment after graduation or who are studying acquired skills that are relevant to their career during a gap year. Travelling or taking time off without engaging in activities seen as beneficial to one's career may be interpreted as lacking resilience or motivation.
Getting Married	
Human will get a huge penalty because of haven't getting married and keep single. Single? -1500	In East Asian culture, being unmarried and single is viewed as highly unacceptable. Parents feel a sense of shame when their children remain unmarried and without families, and relatives and elders frequently bring up the topic of marriage

in casual conversations. There is a prevailing societal belief that unmarried individuals are deemed unsuccessful in life and may even be perceived as having a personality or mental issues.

The females need to speed about three years in the Marriage Toaster, but the males only spend less than a year.



yearMarryM	yearMarryF
float	float
0.5	2.5

Women typically invest more time and effort than men in matters related to marriage and family, and the cost of marriage is considerably higher for them. This pattern can be observed worldwide, but it is particularly pronounced in East Asia. East Asian culture often exhibits a division of roles where men dominate financial aspects and women are expected to contribute more to the family, especially in housework and childcare.

As the game goes on, the difficulty of the educational and occupational conditions of men’s marriage will increase, while the upper age limit of women’s marriage will decrease dramatically.



numMarriage	ageMinM	ageMaxM	ageMinF	ageMaxF	expectEduM
int	int	int	int	int	float
0	18	50	18	38	0.333333333
1	18	49	18	37	0.5
2	19	49	18	37	0.8
3	19	48	18	36	1
4	20	48	18	36	1.25
5	20	47	18	35	1.444444444
6	21	47	18	35	1.666666667
7	21	46	18	34	1.9
8	22	46	18	34	2.357142857
9	22	45	18	33	2.426470588

In East Asia, when it comes to seeking a marriage partner, there are often high expectations regarding men's educational and occupational backgrounds. For example, factors like property ownership and car ownership may be considered. On the other hand, there are strict age requirements imposed on women, with a preference for younger women. This preference is driven by the belief that younger women are in better physical condition and are more capable of bearing children.

The Working Pots have limited capacity, and the better pot will have less capacity

In today's society, finding good jobs has become increasingly challenging and

and stricter educational requirements.



And Players will fail to drag humans to the **silver pot** after the humans are over 36 years old.



demanding. The three different pots symbolize distinct categories of jobs:

Worn-out pots: These represent jobs that can be taken by individuals **aged 16-60**. These jobs often involve **odd tasks or manual labor** and do not require specific qualifications. They have a low entry threshold and generally offer the lowest income.

Silver pots: Symbolizing jobs that are suitable for individuals **aged 21-36**, these positions often involve **general clerical work**. While they require certain educational qualifications, they typically lack core competencies. Individuals in these roles may **face a layoff crisis around the age of 36**, as they can be replaced by newcomers who have just graduated, possess the latest technological skills, and have lower salary expectations.

Pot made by gold: Representing **management positions**, these jobs become available for individuals **aged 26-50**. They require the highest level of education and often individuals in these roles possess advanced qualifications for their age. They advance to the core development level within a company, and some may even hold equity in the organization.

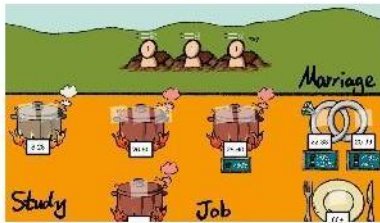
Players will get a penalty if a human fail to **retire** on time.



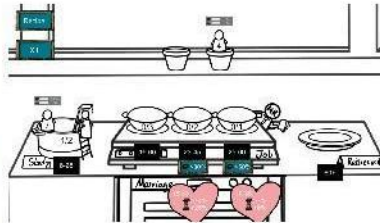
Social Clock will have a **requirement** for the timeline of people's important milestones, which includes **retirement**.

Art Work

Game screenshots



Version 1

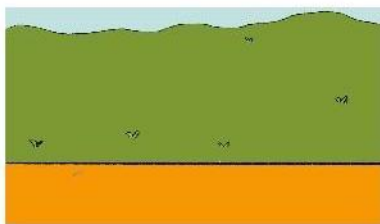


Version 2

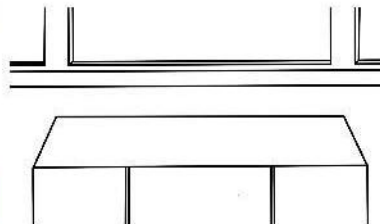


Version 3

Background



Version 1

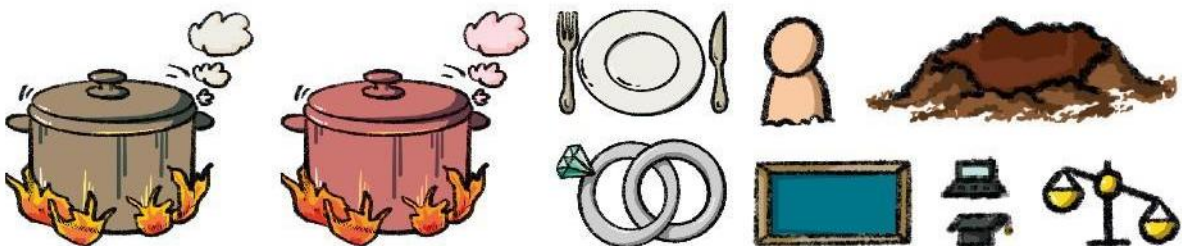


Version 2

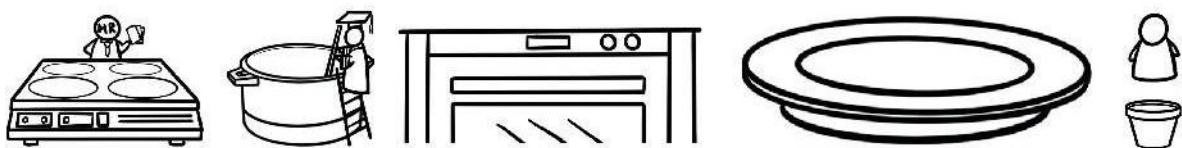


Version 3

Art Elements



Version 1



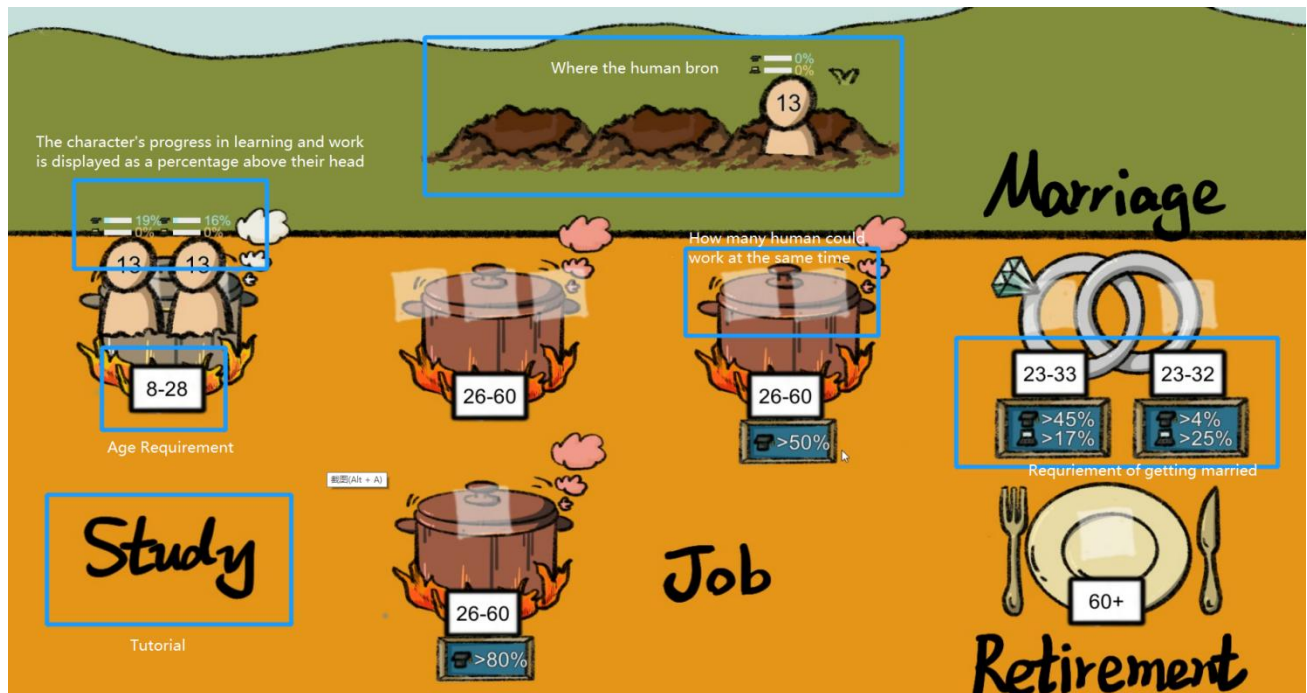
Version 1.1



Version 2

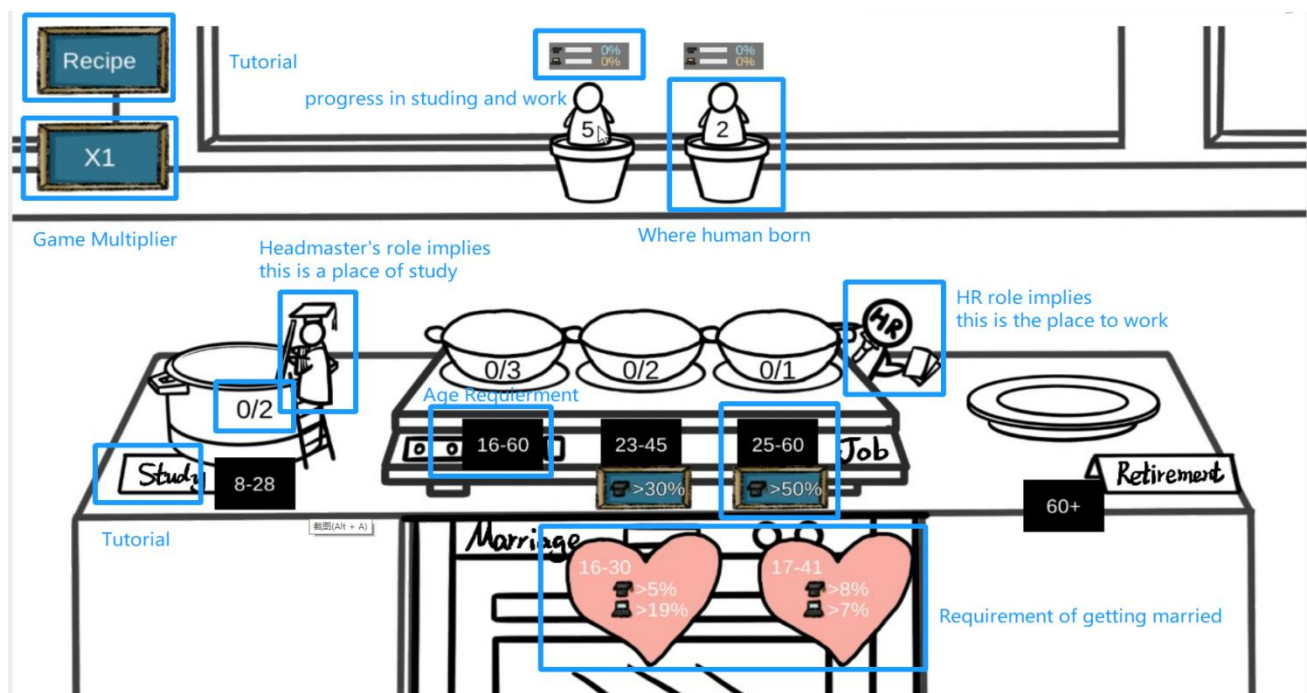
UI Update

Version 1



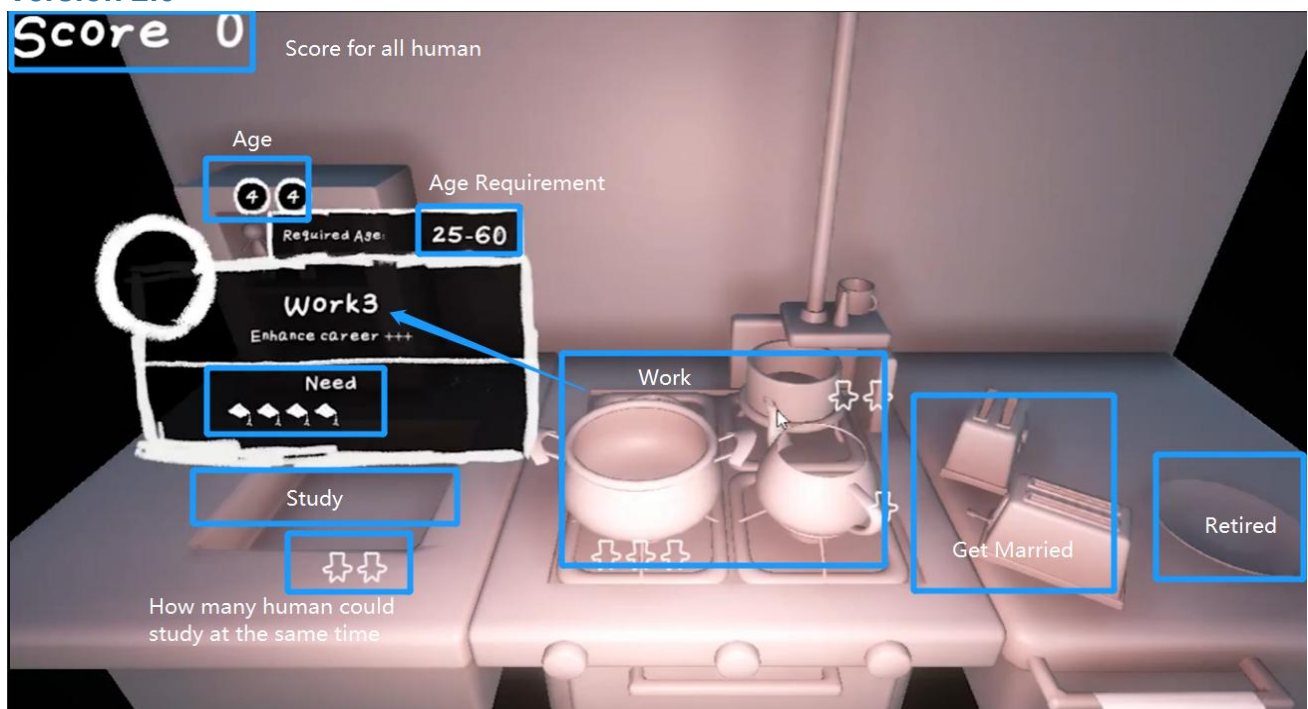
The initial version of the UI design primarily focuses on **presenting essential information** required to **implement the core interactive features**. In this version, the character's learning and work values are represented as percentages, along with the inclusion of random number requirements.

Version 1.1



In version 1.1, I introduced a revised art style. To minimize confusion, **certain random patterns** were made more regular. Based on feedback from players during the previous version's testing phase, I hope to address concerns regarding the cluttered display of study and work requirements by adjusting them to **whole number percentages** (e.g., 40%, 50%). Additionally, I replaced the **hollowed-out pot icon**, which previously indicated the number of people it could accommodate, with **a numerical representation of 0/2**. The intention was to create a **less crowded layout**; however, the abundance of text and data resulted in increased **confusion** for players instead.

Version 2.0



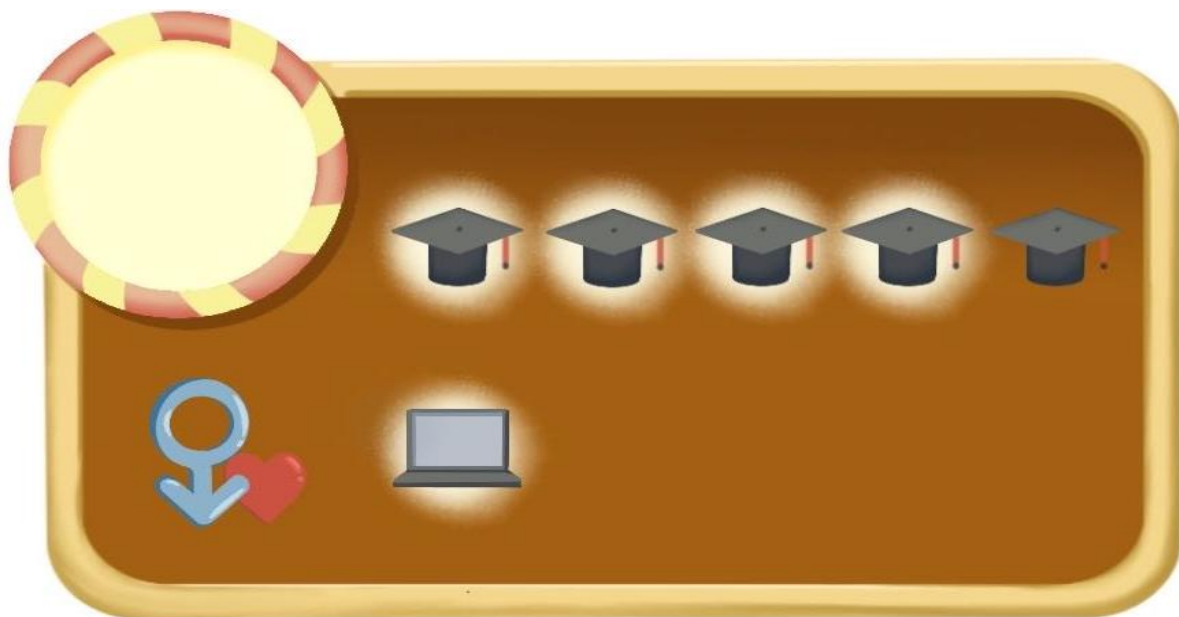
I decided to take things up a notch and transition from **2D to 3D** in this version, **separated the functional bits** of the game from the UI, and **replaced most of the text with easy-to-use icons**.

In this version, I have introduced a new approach by **initially hiding most of the UI screens** and **only revealing them when the mouse hovers over** a specific object. For instance, when the mouse is moved over a pot that represents work, the study requirement will be displayed. This design choice aims to minimize screen clutter and provide a more focused and contextually relevant UI experience for the players.

Unfortunately, after playtesting and feedback from players, the design not only **failed to give**

players the information they needed, but also made them **feel dazzled** by the amount of UI that kept flickering as they moved their mouse.

Version 2.1



I've redesigned the presentation of the UI panels in this version by **fixing the age information in the conditions panel**, such as study and work, to a **fixed position** and **displaying it all the time**, to ensure that players can **easily view** these conditions **without remembering** them. However, in the interest of **saving space**, I still have the **level requirements** such as study, work and other requirements, as well as the information panel

for humans (children), **requiring a mouseover** before displaying.

In addition to this, I have devised **the concept that the marriage conditions** are actually **the matchmaking conditions**, the **requirements of the human's matchmaking partner**. So in this version, I have put the marriage conditions into a **text bubble** to replace the original square box.

Version 2.2



When I worked on the final version of the UI design, Kuko finished modelling and colouring the **background** that **orange** making the original **yellow UI** very **inconspicuous**. To match the background colour, I experimented with a variety of base colours for the UI display box, hoping it would be both **clearly visible** and **harmoniously beautiful**.



I have also added some detailed information to **enhance the player's gaming experience**. For example, I have added **visual icons** for **leveling up**, **married or not**, and **too young** or **too old** for the age requirement.

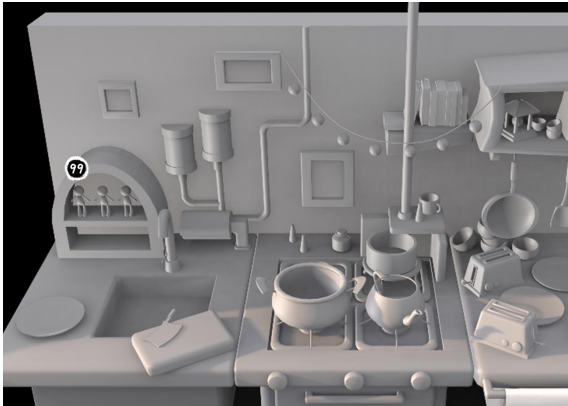


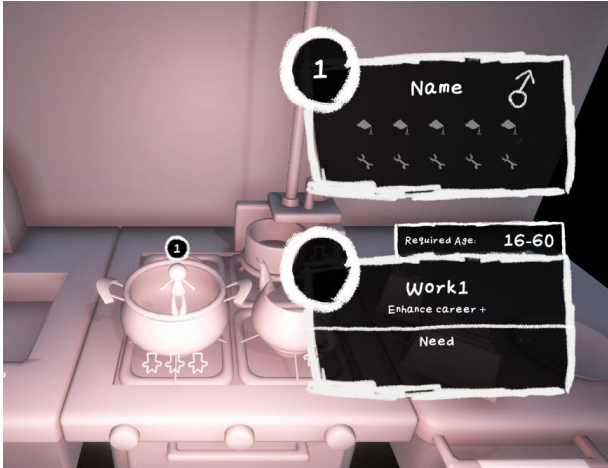
The **checkout page** has also been improved in this version, allowing players to view each person's **biography** at the end, in keeping with the theme of **slice of life**.



Evidence of Process

Ongoing Meetings

Date	Meeting
19th April	● Inner playtest for our prototype ● Discuss the change before Friday's playtest ● Decide to delete the slot on the pot and change the whole cookware to a collider. ● Decide to add a page named Recipe as the beginner's guide.
5th May	● Discuss the priority of the following development. ● Decide to hide a lot of information to simplify the user interface. The full information will be displayed when the player's mouse is above the cookware or the human.
12th May	● Discuss the layout of the 3D scene ✧ There are too many decorations. ✧ The cabinet for humans can be bigger ✧ One pot is for one human  ● Discuss the draft of the UI  ● Discuss the following presentation.
17th May	● Discuss and decide the feedback when we drag the human above the cookware

	 ● Decide to make the needed time different for different sex. For example, females will spend three years in marriage, but males only spend one year. ● Discuss what we want to playtest on Friday.
19th May	● Decide to display the varying marriage conditions permanently. ● Decide to display the educational condition for the jobs permanently. ● Decide to enable players to click the human icon on the ending page to display detailed comments for each human. ● Optimise the camera and the placement layout of the cookware.
24th May	● Decide to put an extra human model on the marriage toaster to act as the human searching for marriage. ● Discuss the art style, for example, the colour of the UI and the texture of the 3D models. ● Discuss how to optimise the UI. ● Decide to change the UI of retirement to slide in from the right-top corner and won't pause the time.
29th May	● Talk with each other about each other's process. ● Decide to load the formal 3D models into Unity this Wednesday. ● Further discuss how we can design and modify the gameplay system, for example, the parent's effort system. ● Discuss the details of UI.
3rd June	● Players will get more penalties for refreshing the marriage condition through the parent's efforts system. ● Add the penalties for the 'gap year' when humans are resting at home after 16 years old. ● Reduce the maximum age limit for some jobs.

Playtest Feedback & Game Version Updates

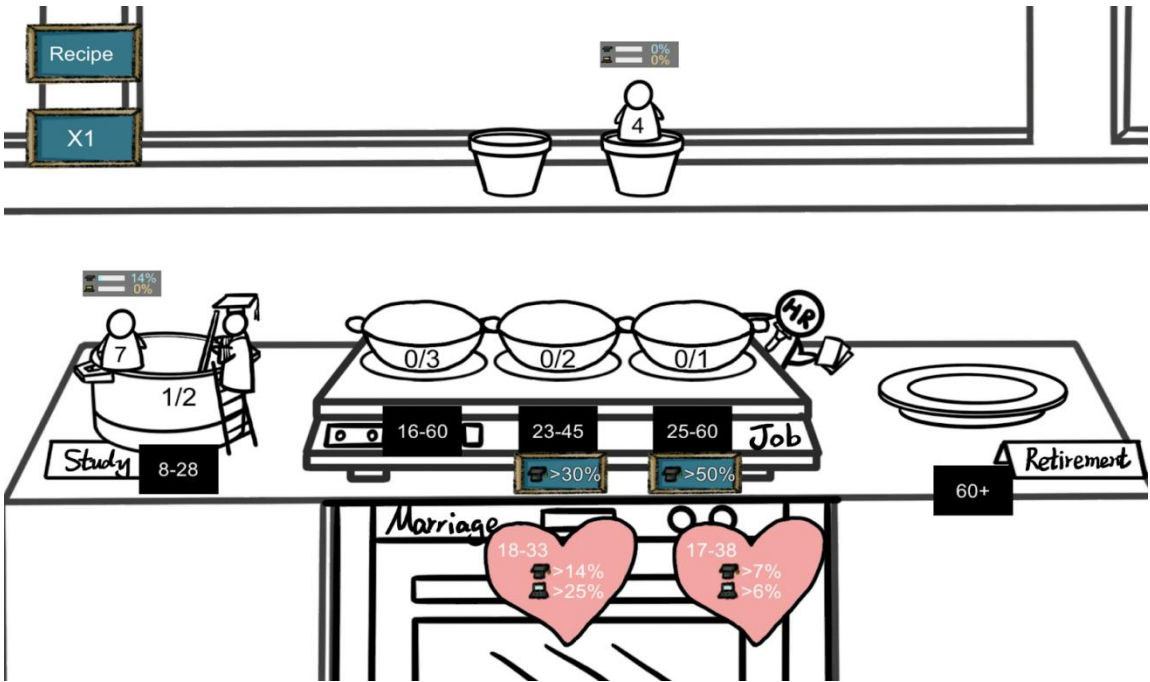
V1.0 (19th April)

Group Members	
Cheng Min	Ideal Owner / Game Design / Game Art
Joshua (Hongpeng Luo)	Game Development / Game Design

Prototype		
Feedback	Analysis	Improvement
The interaction isn't convenient when dragging the human to the pots.	Each slot represents one position for a human, and the player needs to drag the human accurately to the slot, which causes inconvenience.	In version 1.1, we expand the collision area to the whole pot so that the players can drag the human to the pot itself, and there will be a mark showing the capacity.

V1.1 (21st April)

Group Members	
Cheng Min	Ideal Owner / Game Design / Game Art
Joshua (Hongpeng Luo)	Game Development / Game Design

Prototype		
		
Feedback	Analysis	Improvement
[Xuan Long] I want to have some visual feedback when the player can drag the human into the school.	In this version, the '8-28' means recommended age for school, but actually, players can drag the children to study before the year of 8, which may cause confusion because of a lack of guidance.	In version 2.0, we marked the age as the recommended age. What's more, we plan to change the 'pushing human study early' to a special skill of players, which needs to unlock using the score in version 2.2.
[Xuan Long] Hope to see the total score all the time during the gameplay.	The total score can provide some sense of achievement and help players know the game's progress.	In version 2.0, we add the total score UI to the left-top corner.
[Ruimeng Gu]	In this version, we introduce	In version 2.2, we plan to

I feel that the player's role is similar to a great parent of a family with many children. I suggest you consider changing the identity of the player.	that the player is the newbie god of Social Clock, and he isn't familiar with the duty of Social Clock. The goal of players is to keep generating humans and getting higher scores. Continuing the bloodline doesn't seem to be the duty of the god of the Social Clock, but it is close to the wish of a great parent.	change the perspective of the player and introduce it in the tutorial.
[SuHuan Cai] The EXP bar on the top of the character for study and work is too small to read. [David King] There are so many numbers in this game, and it is easy to misunderstand what they represent.	That is because in this version, there is so much information displayed permanently, which also fails to highlight the importance of age in this game.	In version 2.0, which is a formal version instead of a prototype, we plan to change the scene into 3D so that we can hide most of the UI but keep displaying the age to highlight the significance of age. What's more, the 2D UI can be separated from the 3D object naturally.
[Suhuan Cai] The collision for the marriage sometimes fails.	That is because we didn't apply collision detection for the informative UI. However, players may want to drag human to the UI, which cause inconvenience.	In version 2.2, we apply raycasting on the informative UI, and players can also drag the human to the UI to bind the human with cookware, which enhances convenience.
[Dixuan Xu] There is no feedback when dragging a person into a marriage toaster, but the conditions are not reached.	This is a design bug because in this version, when players drag humans to the toaster, two conditions will be checked, and it is confusing to broadcast two kinds of feedback at the same time.	In version 2.0, we bind only one condition of marriage to exactly one toaster so that conflict won't happen, and we can broadcast the feedback of exactly which toaster the player drags the human to.
[Dixuan Xu] After the human gets married, feedback indicating that the human is married is needed, for example, an apron.	In this version, we don't have time to apply UI showing the marital status of the human.	In version 2.1, on the UI page of the human, there is a heart icon that means the human is married.

																																																				
[Zixin Yao] I suggest different jobs can be labelled with different UI.	In this version, we don't have time to create different assets for different pots. What's more, we haven't applied the UI that indicated the different speeds in the growth of career value for different pots. Thus, it is hard for players to tell the difference between different pots.	In version 2.0, we use different pots in different shapes to replace different kinds of jobs. What's more, we also display the age requirement UI besides the pots in version 2.1.																																																		
[Zixin Yao] When the game is over, players may tend to click the human-on-plate icon displayed on the UI page to check the comments given by the Social Clock.	It may give players a sense of achievement if they can check each human's status and comments after a game.	We plan to enable players to check each human's status after a game if we have time.																																																		
[Dong Li & Kejia Cheng] The difficulty of marriage could be designed to gradually increase.	According to flow theory, it is better to increase difficulty or give players some challenges after the players get familiar with the game, preventing them from getting bored.	In version 2.1, we started to use Excel tables to control the difficulty of marriage. As the time of marriage increases, the difficulty of marriage will also increase. <table><tr><th>numMarriage</th><th>ageMinM</th><th>ageMaxM</th><th>ageMinF</th><th>ageMaxF</th></tr><tr><th>int</th><th>int</th><th>int</th><th>int</th><th>int</th></tr><tr><td>0</td><td>18</td><td>50</td><td>18</td><td>38</td></tr><tr><td>2</td><td>18</td><td>49</td><td>18</td><td>37</td></tr><tr><td>4</td><td>19</td><td>49</td><td>18</td><td>37</td></tr><tr><td>6</td><td>19</td><td>48</td><td>18</td><td>36</td></tr><tr><td>8</td><td>20</td><td>48</td><td>18</td><td>36</td></tr><tr><td>10</td><td>20</td><td>47</td><td>18</td><td>35</td></tr><tr><td>12</td><td>21</td><td>47</td><td>18</td><td>35</td></tr><tr><td>14</td><td>21</td><td>46</td><td>18</td><td>34</td></tr></table>	numMarriage	ageMinM	ageMaxM	ageMinF	ageMaxF	int	int	int	int	int	0	18	50	18	38	2	18	49	18	37	4	19	49	18	37	6	19	48	18	36	8	20	48	18	36	10	20	47	18	35	12	21	47	18	35	14	21	46	18	34
numMarriage	ageMinM	ageMaxM	ageMinF	ageMaxF																																																
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[David King] If the social context of the game is East Asian, what about designing the cookware and kitchen using the Asian style?	The kitchen in Asia nowadays is similar to European, and we don't tend to design it using the ancient Asian kitchen element because the phenomenon of the Social Clock that we want to talk about focuses on modern society.	We decided to design the kitchen in a common style.																																																		

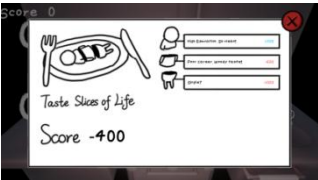
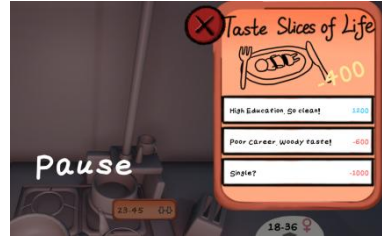
V2.0 (19th May)

Group Members	
Cheng Min	Ideal Owner / Game Design / Game 2D Art
Joshua (Hongpeng Luo)	Game Development / Game Design
Jiage Li	Game 3D Art / Game Design

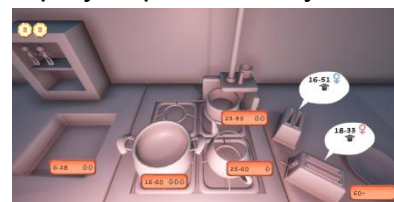
the first version in 3D with basic functions



Feedback	Analysis	Improvement
[Hanjun Shi] I failed to learn that the toaster represents marriage at the beginning. [Ruiment Gu] The function of each kind of cookware isn't clear in the aspect of the introduction.	In this version, we don't have enough time to implement tutorials. What's more, there isn't any text explaining that the toaster represents marriage.	In version 2.2, we implement a tutorial at the beginning to tell players what the different cookwares represent.
[Hanjun Shi] It is inconvenient to keep the mouse above the human model to check their status frequently.	Firstly, in this version, we hide all the information, except the age of humans, to highlight the significance of the age, which causes inconvenience. Secondly, the UI page doesn't follow the human model's position, which makes players hard to tell which human the UI information belongs to. 	In version 2.1, since we still tend to highlight the significance of age, we optimize the mouse hover interaction. When players put the mouse above the model of a human, the age UI above the human will transform and expand to a detailed UI page, making it more convenient to read. 
[Hanjun Shi] I ignore the Level Up tip. 	The information on the Level Up tip isn't obvious and doesn't last for a long time. Thus players tend to put the mouse on the human model to read the detailed information.	The LEVEL UP tip can make the game juicier, and thus we tend to keep it. We plan to optimize the Level Up tip in the future.
[Ruimeng Gu] The concept conveyed by the UI Icons isn't clear.	The icons in this version are just for testing the visual interaction. Thus, they are not the formal version and are drawn by the	In version 2.1, the icons drawn by the artist are implemented in the game, and the expression of the

	programmer.	icons becomes clearer. 
[Ruimeng Gu] It seems that the toaster needs two more human models on them.	Exactly. Adding a human model to the toaster can explain why the toaster has different requirements for sex.	In version 2.2, we added a human model of different sex to the required sex, which makes the requirement become a page of marriage search. 
[Ruimeng Gu] The Retire UI Page after the retirement break or interrupt the playing experience. 	That is because our game is a fast-paced game and even don't have a permanent pause button. The Retire UI Page covers the whole screen and pauses the game will exactly disrupting the pace of the game.	In version 2.1, we modified the Retire UI Page. It will slice in from the right and only cover part of the screen. What's more, it won't pause the game unless players click the page. 
[Ruimeng Gu] Age requirement of the job is strict, but humans can study before the recommended age, which seems like a bug.	We aim to add some hidden interaction showing that parents send their children to school earlier and can get some extra scores. However, there is no hint, and the UI of age only show 8 to 28, which will confuse the players.	In version 2.2, the players can't drag the children into the studying sink out of the range of age that the UI tip shows. The function that makes the minimum age of studying can unlock through the parent's effort system.

		
[Ruimeng Gu] The total score should be reduced if the character has not retired after retirement age.	Actually, we plan to add this feature if we have enough time because retiring on time is also a requirement from the Social Clock.	In version 2.2, the players will get a penalty for retiring late. What's more, there will also be a warning if players don't retire on time. 
[Ruimeng Gu] The camera lens should be closer to interactable objects.	If the camera becomes closer, players can see the game items more clearly.	In version 2.1, we modify the camera. 
[Ruimeng Gu] The gender needs to be indicated on each toaster (using textures).	In this version, it is inconvenient for players to recognize the sex of the human, which makes the players check the information of humans frequently.	In version 2.2, the texture on the human models can indicate the sex of the human. 
[Ruimeng Gu] Marriage requirements for male and female characters are similar.	That is because we didn't have time to implement the difference according to sexuality through Excel.	In version 2.1, we implement the difference in the marriage requirement. For example, the male will require

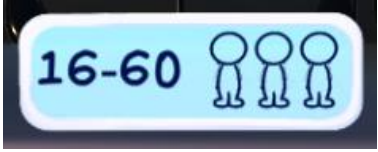
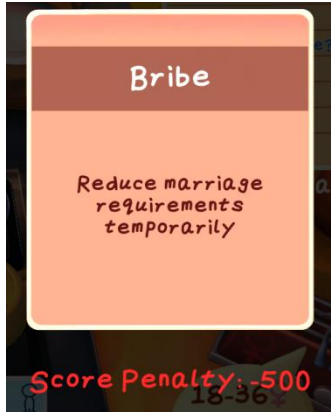
		education and a good career, while the female will be in the face of strict age conditions.																																																																														
[Ruimeng Gu] Requirements that will change need to be displayed all the time.	That is because if the requirement changes, but we don't display the change, players will be difficult to notice the change and get confused.	In version 2.1, most of the requirements will be displayed permanently. 																																																																														
[Ruimeng Gu] I don't know the meaning of the score.	A leaderboard can help players to record their scores and rank them. However, without the leaderboard, the score itself is also an important feature, which can show the evaluation from Social Clock. We need to add more detailed rules for scoring first.	In version 2.1, we design an Excel Table for designing the scoring system systematically. <table><tr><th colspan="2">//dontCare</th><th colspan="2"></th><th colspan="2">//dontChange</th></tr><tr><th>id</th><th>scoreType</th><th>keyValue</th><th>desc</th><th>init</th><th>slope</th></tr><tr><td>int</td><td>enum RetireScoreType</td><td>int</td><td>string</td><td>int</td><td>int</td></tr><tr><td>1001</td><td>Edu</td><td>0</td><td>Poor Education.</td><td>-1200</td><td>30</td></tr><tr><td>1002</td><td>Edu</td><td>40</td><td>Normal Education.</td><td>-1000</td><td>25</td></tr><tr><td>1003</td><td>Edu</td><td>80</td><td>High Education.</td><td>-1800</td><td>35</td></tr><tr><td>1011</td><td>EduStart</td><td>0</td><td>Early School!</td><td>400</td><td>-30</td></tr><tr><td>1012</td><td>EduStart</td><td>8</td><td></td><td>0</td><td>0</td></tr><tr><td>1013</td><td>EduStart</td><td>12</td><td>Late for School!</td><td>800</td><td>-80</td></tr><tr><td>1021</td><td>DelayGraduate</td><td>1</td><td>Delay Graduate?</td><td>0</td><td>-100</td></tr><tr><td>2001</td><td>Career</td><td>0</td><td>Poor Career.</td><td>-900</td><td>30</td></tr><tr><td>2002</td><td>Career</td><td>30</td><td>Normal Career.</td><td>-900</td><td>30</td></tr><tr><td>2003</td><td>Career</td><td>70</td><td>Nice Career.</td><td>-1250</td><td>35</td></tr></table>	//dontCare				//dontChange		id	scoreType	keyValue	desc	init	slope	int	enum RetireScoreType	int	string	int	int	1001	Edu	0	Poor Education.	-1200	30	1002	Edu	40	Normal Education.	-1000	25	1003	Edu	80	High Education.	-1800	35	1011	EduStart	0	Early School!	400	-30	1012	EduStart	8		0	0	1013	EduStart	12	Late for School!	800	-80	1021	DelayGraduate	1	Delay Graduate?	0	-100	2001	Career	0	Poor Career.	-900	30	2002	Career	30	Normal Career.	-900	30	2003	Career	70	Nice Career.	-1250	35
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[Ruimeng Gu] The materials of different pots can be made to suggest that each pot has different job requirements and effects.	In this version, players fail to tell the difference between these three pots because we haven't implemented the materials of the 3D model. Otherwise, the model can indicate the function of the pots. What's more, the description of cookware isn't clear.	In version 2.2, the pots for jobs in different levels are designed in different shapes, which can indicate different efficiency of improving the value of the career.																																																																														

V2.1 (26th May)

the version with improved interaction



Feedback	Analysis	Improvement
[Long Xuan] Players may need a leaderboard. [Suzy] I want to have a leaderboard.	Although there is similar feedback in the last version, we didn't have enough time to implement it. A leaderboard can help players to record their own score and compare it with history.	In version 2.2, we implement the leaderboard system. 
[Long Xuan] The game was a bit confusing at the beginning, misunderstanding that the three pots represent study, work and marriage separately. What about adding a tutorial at the beginning?	A tutorial can help players to understand what each kind of cookware represents.	In version 2.2, we implement the tutorial system at the beginning of the game. 
[Long Xuan] The board above the second pot will block the player's view and affect the player to drag the character.	The board above the pot actually doesn't have a collider, but it will visually block the player's view.	In version 2.2, we moved the board to the left corner. 

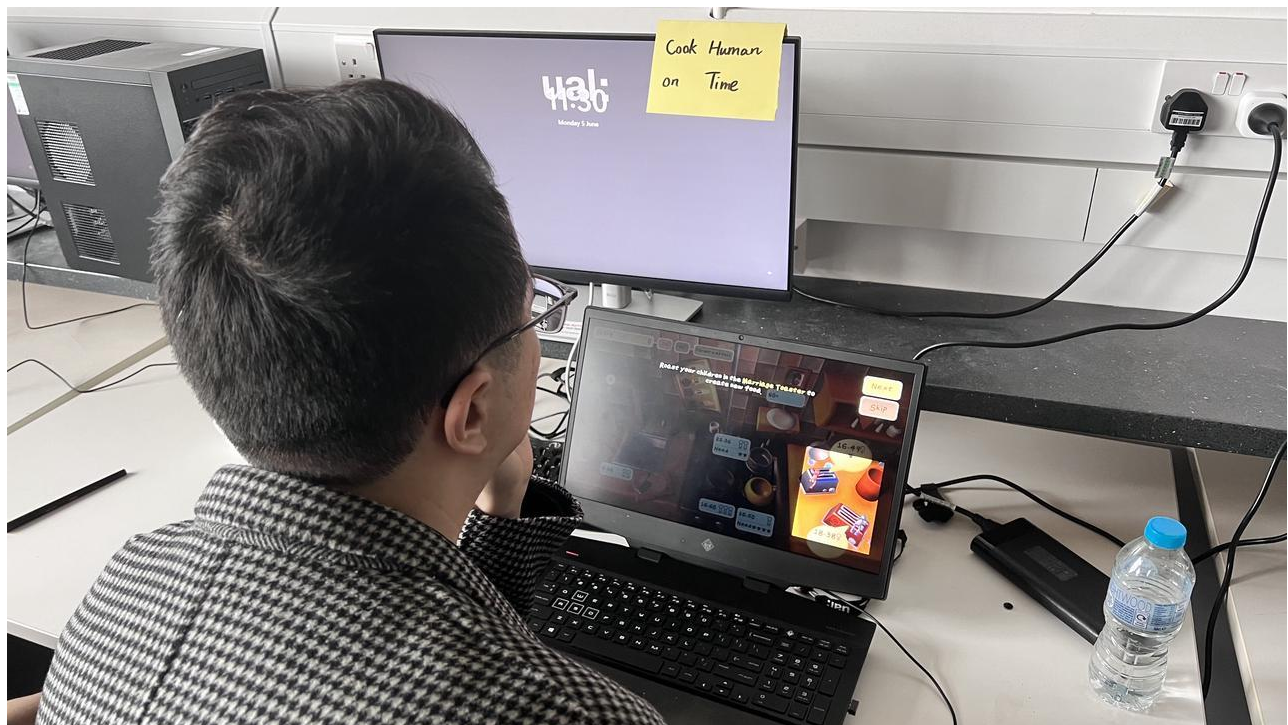
[Long Xuan] I didn't realise that there is a limit to the number of humans in each pot.	The icon of capacity is drawn by the programmer, and it is not clear. 	In version 2.2, we modify the icon of capacity. 
[KeJia Cheng & David King] The size of the collider is a bit small and make it inconvenient to drag human. [Richard] When a player moves the character, if the character's condition does not satisfy the working or learning requirements, the character's model should return to the previous position rather than the original shelf.	Actually, the function of putting the human back to the last pot has been implemented in the beginning. (But humans must be sent back home after marriage so that they can be evaluated by HR one more time.) The reason causing this confusion is the model of the third pot is incomplete, and the programmer applied a mesh collider for it.	In version 2.2, we replaced the model with the finished one and used a capsule collider for some pots. What's more, there is a bug in the ray cast system, and we also fix it. 
[KeJia Cheng & Suzy] I will get stuck because of the too-difficult marriage condition.	In this version, the difficulty is too hard for players, and in some situations, players can't meet the requirement at any situation.	We implemented a parent's effort system, and players can refresh the marriage requirement by costing the score. 
[KeJia Cheng] Players will try to drag the human model into the UI. [Richard] It is better to add an extra collider for the UI.	Adding a collider on the UI binding to the cookware can make it more convenient for players to drag humans into the cookware.	In version 2.2, we add a tag on the UI, and when players drop the human on the tagged UI, the human will bind with the corresponding cookware.

[Richard] I can feel what you want to convey.		Nothing changes.
[Richard] I love the concept that the requirement of marriage will randomly change.	If the marriage condition doesn't change, the players will get bored easily because the game steps will be fixed.	Nothing changes.
[Richard] At the beginning, an education and career icon should show on the human UI page so that the player will know what to do.	In this version, the UI Page of the human doesn't have any icons at the beginning, and players will have no idea about what are education and career. 	In version 2.2, we display the education and career icons on the UI page of humans at the beginning. 
[Richard] When the player drags a character model, the game can hint at where that character can go.	We got this feedback because players want to drag humans to the pots easily. However, we want players to drag the humans to the pots actively and be rejected by the pots or the Social Clock. In this case, players can receive negative feedback to learn about the social clock and feel the message. Thus, we don't want to follow this feedback.	Nothing changed.
[Richard] Players should have more options, and if the player does not want the human to study or work, the game should offer the player other options.	The players can have more options, but the Social Clock won't allow them. In this case, the other options will be summarized as resting on the cabinet, which will be considered as a gap year and cause a penalty.	Nothing changed.
[Suzy] The only random feature is the marriage requirement, considering adding some unexpected or random events.	It will be better if we design some twists for the players. In this version, the procedure of cooking a human is fixed, and thus players may get bored easily.	In version 2.2, we introduced a parent's effort system, empowering players to enhance the parents (players' role) 'abilities by selecting random skills, thereby providing an easier gameplay experience.

		
[Suzy] The plate of retirement isn't obvious.	In this version, the plate is hidden behind the UI of marriage and makes it difficult for players to drag humans into it.	In version 2.2, we change the position of the plate, and players can get access to it easily now. 
[Suzy] The UI of the pot is expected to be displayed all the time.	It is inconvenient for players to read the educational requirement for the jobs in this version.	In version 2.2, we display the educational requirement for the job permanently.
[Suzy] The UI of retirement should automatically slice back off-screen.	Actually, in this version, the UI page will slice back automatically, but players may not notice this feature. A progress bar about the countdown time may help.	In version 2.2, we add a progress bar indicating the remaining time for displaying the retire UI page. 

the version with formal 3D models and 2D UI assets





Feedback	Analysis	Improvement
[David King] The game needs a start page.	A start page can make a game look with a high degree of completion.	In version 2.3, we add a start page. 
[David King] Some keywords in the tutorial need to highlight, for example, career and education.	Highlighting the key values about human status can give the players a clearer concept of the game.	In version 2.3, we highlight the keyword career and education, and we even explain it using the UI icon. 
[David King] I fail to notice that the 1X and 2X are controlling the game speed.	Maybe we can refer to the speed control button of some simulation game.  	

[David King] When players can choose the parent's effort, the button is not obvious, and the player may ignore it. [Core] I fail to notice the parent's effort button. 	That is because the pace of the game is so fast that players may ignore the unlock of the parent's effort button.																	
[David King] The feedback tip of 'Not gay' seems offensive, and consider changing it into 'I am finding a woman'.	We plan to record some comedy sound effects for our game, but some of the effects seem offensive, and we consider to replace them in the next version.	In version 2.3, we change the sound effect and the content of the tip. 																
[David King] I will consider the red colour in the score of the retirement page to be close to the penalty instead of the blue shade.	We chose a red colour for a positive score because our main colour is a warm tone, and a blue colour will stand out and attract players' attention, which suits a negative score. However, some players think red colour is better for representing negative scores.	In version 2.3, we exchange the colour of the comment.  <table><tr><th>Option</th><th>Score</th></tr><tr><td>Normal Education</td><td>525</td></tr><tr><td>Early School!</td><td>220</td></tr><tr><td>Delay Graduate?</td><td>-100</td></tr><tr><td>Nice Career</td><td>2250</td></tr><tr><td>Quick Marry</td><td>500</td></tr><tr><td>Retire on time!</td><td>500</td></tr><tr><td>Gap 2 Year?</td><td>-100</td></tr></table>	Option	Score	Normal Education	525	Early School!	220	Delay Graduate?	-100	Nice Career	2250	Quick Marry	500	Retire on time!	500	Gap 2 Year?	-100
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[Li Dong] I misunderstand that the blue background of the UI page of the cookware means only men can bind with this cookware.	Actually, the blue shade of the cookware UI is trying to make a difference from the UI of the marriage condition. We never expect that players will misunderstand this blue colour represents looking for a guy.																	

[Li Dong] The word 'need' on the gold teapot UI is too close to the education icon, causing me to misread the educational requirement of the teapot.	That is because the font size of the text 'Need' is too big, and we plan to make it smaller. 	In version 2.3, we optimised the layout of the UI of cookware and make it clearer. 																																																																		
[Cora] I didn't understand the mechanics of the toaster, didn't know that it only needs one human to create a baby, and didn't realise it until the third game. [Cora] The tutorial can be more detailed.	In this version, our tutorial just simply introduces what each cookware represents but fails to teach the players the detail of interaction. We plan to add more steps to the tutorial.																																																																			
[Cora] The pace of the game is too fast for me, and thus I fail to notice the metaphor hidden in the game, for example, noticing females need more time for marriage. Consider increasing the game speed as the difficulty increases. [Sakuyo] The experience after creating about 15 babies seems repetitive, and I think the pace of the game is slow for me, and thus I play the game at double speed. [Li Dong] The double speed is too fast for me.	Different players will have different speeds of understanding and learning. What's more, the reaction speed is also different. Therefore, it would be better to let players start this game at a relatively slow pace and then speed up the pace as players get familiar with this game. In this case, the fast pace won't prevent the players from understanding what the game conveys at the beginning and then feeling age anxiety after the game accelerate.	In version 2.3, we optimised the game speed. When the game starts, a year in the game will be 1.8 seconds, and it will gradually accelerate to 1.15 seconds per year. <table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th>id</th><th>numMarriage</th><th>timeOfYear</th></tr> <tr> <th>int</th><th>int</th><th>float</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr><td>1001</td><td>0</td><td>1.8</td></tr> <tr><td>1002</td><td>1</td><td>1.7</td></tr> <tr><td>1003</td><td>2</td><td>1.6</td></tr> <tr><td>1004</td><td>3</td><td>1.6</td></tr> <tr><td>1005</td><td>4</td><td>1.55</td></tr> <tr><td>1006</td><td>5</td><td>1.55</td></tr> <tr><td>1007</td><td>6</td><td>1.5</td></tr> <tr><td>1008</td><td>7</td><td>1.5</td></tr> <tr><td>1009</td><td>8</td><td>1.45</td></tr> <tr><td>1010</td><td>9</td><td>1.45</td></tr> <tr><td>1011</td><td>10</td><td>1.4</td></tr> <tr><td>1012</td><td>12</td><td>1.4</td></tr> <tr><td>1013</td><td>14</td><td>1.35</td></tr> <tr><td>1014</td><td>16</td><td>1.35</td></tr> <tr><td>1015</td><td>18</td><td>1.3</td></tr> <tr><td>1016</td><td>20</td><td>1.3</td></tr> <tr><td>1017</td><td>22</td><td>1.25</td></tr> <tr><td>1018</td><td>24</td><td>1.25</td></tr> <tr><td>1019</td><td>26</td><td>1.2</td></tr> <tr><td>1020</td><td>28</td><td>1.15</td></tr> </tbody> </table>	id	numMarriage	timeOfYear	int	int	float	1001	0	1.8	1002	1	1.7	1003	2	1.6	1004	3	1.6	1005	4	1.55	1006	5	1.55	1007	6	1.5	1008	7	1.5	1009	8	1.45	1010	9	1.45	1011	10	1.4	1012	12	1.4	1013	14	1.35	1014	16	1.35	1015	18	1.3	1016	20	1.3	1017	22	1.25	1018	24	1.25	1019	26	1.2	1020	28	1.15
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[Maddy] You can add some text about the details of Social Clock on the About Page,	Although players may recognize what we want to convey during the game, it would be better to add																																																																			

explaining the metaphor in the mechanic. [Cora] What about adding a button that can show the explanation of the metaphor of the game after clicking it?	some clear explanation at some place to explain what we want to convey to answer players' questions.	
[Maddy] I think this game is good, and I can understand what you want to convey, though this game is hard for me.		Nothing changed.

Critical Reflection

1. Mechanic

In summary, it is undeniable that our game takes a strong stance against the concept of the social clock. We have intentionally crafted gameplay mechanics and incorporated elements that highlight the absurdity and oppressive nature of societal expectations. By integrating the concept of a social clock into the kitchen game and utilizing exaggerated and comical elements, we aim to create a humorous experience that challenges traditional norms.

Throughout the game, we symbolically represent various life stages and expectations. The actions of washing ingredients, putting them in the pot, marriage, and tasting on a plate all serve as metaphors for different aspects of life. These representations aim to provoke reflection on the challenges and pressures individuals face as they navigate through society's predetermined timelines.

Furthermore, I have consciously included elements that shed light on the intense pressures experienced by women within the social clock framework. By addressing issues such as the time invested in marriage and the objectification of women, I strive to spark dialogue and raise awareness about gender roles and societal expectations.

I was very impressed with Joshua's excellent voice acting in previous projects. For this game, I strongly encourage Joshua to do the voiceover. Joshua's remarkable voiceover work further enhances the game's satirical tone. His unconventional approach, characterized by exaggerated and absurd sound effects, adds to the overall comedic experience. The unexpectedness of the wacky voiceovers contrasting with the characters' images serves as a catalyst for laughter, ensuring an enjoyable and engaging gameplay.

By challenging the social clock and utilizing humor as a tool, our game encourages players to question societal norms, foster critical thinking, and promote inclusivity and individual autonomy.

2. UI Update

When it comes to designing the game UI, we encountered a significant hurdle that demanded our utmost attention and creativity. Our game is packed with an extensive

amount of crucial data that simply cannot be overlooked. We understand the vital importance of ensuring players have access to this information, as it directly impacts their understanding and progression within the game.

In contrast to games like *Overcook*, where simplicity reigns supreme, our game delves into intricate depths, requiring the display of numerous essential data points. We refuse to compromise on providing players with the necessary knowledge to make informed decisions and navigate the complexities of our gameplay. Unlike *Overcook*, where the icons represent simple objects like food and pots, our game incorporates deeper meanings and symbolism. The pots in our game represent work and have specific usage conditions, while the food consists of human characters. This added complexity requires us to present information in a way that is both visually appealing and informative.

While we understand the importance of maintaining a clean UI, we also recognize the need to display the necessary data that players must be aware of. In order to strike a balance, we have carefully designed our UI to effectively convey the required information without overwhelming the players visually. We have employed techniques such as a hierarchical organization that separates UI and items from 2d to 3d, intuitive labelling, and concise yet informative tooltips to ensure that players have access to the relevant data without sacrificing the overall user experience.

Our goal is to create a UI that effectively communicates essential information while maintaining a visually pleasing aesthetic. We understand that the abundance of data in our game may pose challenges, but we are committed to finding innovative solutions that streamline the UI and enhance the player's understanding of the game mechanics and objectives.

3. Future Enhancement Proposal

In our future development plans, we have outlined three key aspects that we can consider:

Background Culture:

Indeed, it is true that our game concepts, mechanics design, and metaphors are deeply rooted in our East Asian cultural background, which may limit the universal appeal of the game. While it can be challenging to cater to the preferences and cultural understanding of all players, as game designers, we strive to create experiences that transcend cultural boundaries and convey meaningful messages.

To address this concern, we can explore ways to make the metaphorical messages more apparent and provide hints and clues for players who may not be familiar with the cultural context. This can be achieved through various means, such as incorporating subtle visual cues, utilizing in-game dialogue or narration to provide context, or even offering optional informational resources that players can access to gain a deeper understanding of the social clock concept and we can bridge the cultural gap and raise awareness about the existence and pressures associated with the social clock.

It is important for us as game designers to strike a balance between preserving the cultural authenticity of our game and ensuring that the messages and themes can resonate with a wider audience. By implementing these strategies, we can create a more inclusive gaming experience that fosters understanding and empathy, even for players who may not be familiar with the specific cultural background from which our game originates.

Level Design:

We can focus on enhancing the level design of the game to provide players with engaging and challenging gameplay experiences. This includes designing levels with a variety of obstacles for social clock requirements, introducing new mechanics, and creating innovative puzzles or tasks which have special meanings in real life for players to solve. By carefully crafting each level, we can ensure a progressive difficulty curve and keep players immersed and motivated throughout their gameplay journey.

Expanded Work Mechanics:

In addition to gaining experience, we can introduce the concept of earning money through work activities in the game. This adds a new layer of gameplay depth, allowing players to not only progress by increasing their levels but also by accumulating wealth. The earned money can then be used to purchase new human characters, expand the available positions in the kitchen, or acquire other useful items and upgrades that enhance gameplay efficiency or provide additional benefits.

By incorporating these elements into the game, we plan to create a more immersive and dynamic gameplay experience. Players may have the opportunity to strategically manage their resources, making decisions on how to best allocate their earned money for maximum efficiency and progression. This adds aim to depth to the gameplay mechanics and provides

players with a sense of progression and accomplishment as they unlock new characters, expand their operations, and utilize various tools and items to enhance their gameplay strategies.